Who Do We Ask? Questions About Dad's Situation, Sorted by Who Can Answer

Fifteen questions for the care team, the main caregiver, the family, Dad and a care consultant, with room to write what they say.

This week you're talking with several people, and each of them holds a different part of the answer. Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write what you hear under each one.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. The people below are the ones who know Dad's situation.

The care team

Whoever is treating Dad right now. In a hospital that may be a doctor, a nurse, a discharge planner or a social worker. At home it may be his regular doctor's office.

1. What has changed with Dad, as you see it, and since when?

2. Who is coordinating his care right now, and who should our family call with questions?

3. What decision does our family need to make next, and is there a date attached to it?

4. What do you need from the family before that decision, and who do we give it to?

5. Can we have what you've told us in writing? If a record needs Dad's permission before you can share it with us, what does your office need from him?

The person who helps Dad most

The relative, friend or paid caregiver who is there more than anyone else. If that's you, answer these yourself, on paper.

1. What do you do for Dad on an ordinary day, from the morning through the night?

2. Which of those things are getting harder for you to keep doing?

3. What has changed in the last few weeks that the rest of us may not have seen?

The family

Brothers, sisters and anyone else who has a part. Ask each person separately if you can. If the answers don't match, write down each one.

1. What do you actually do for Dad now, and how often?

2. What have you been told about his situation, by whom, and on what day?

3. Which tasks do you think someone else has covered, and have you checked with them?

4. Who do you believe is coordinating things right now?

5. Who will be the family's contact for now, and who is the backup?

Dad

1. Here is what we've written down about what's happened. Does it sound right to you, and what did we leave out?

Your care consultant

The person who interviews the family and looks at the whole arrangement: where Dad lives, how a typical day goes, and who is doing what.

1. Here is what we've written down so far. What else would you want to know about Dad's situation before the next decision?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions or put them in order of importance. You know which one matters most to your family this week. Start there.

Ready for the next step?

You know what to ask and who can answer, and the answers are starting to come in. The care interview gives them somewhere to go: it walks through Dad's situation area by area, checks what's been left out, and turns what you've learned into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Two of the care-team questions, who to call with questions and getting what you're told in writing, follow what the Family Caregiver Alliance's discharge guide and Medicare's discharge planning checklist suggest families ask. The other questions and the grouping by role are the Family Care Roadmap's own.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers
2. Medicare (Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services), Your discharge planning checklist

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From the Family Care Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.